LESSON 1

Rain, Rain, Go Away

A rhyme children have chanted on rainy days for hundreds of years: one version was printed in 1659, in a book of English proverbs.

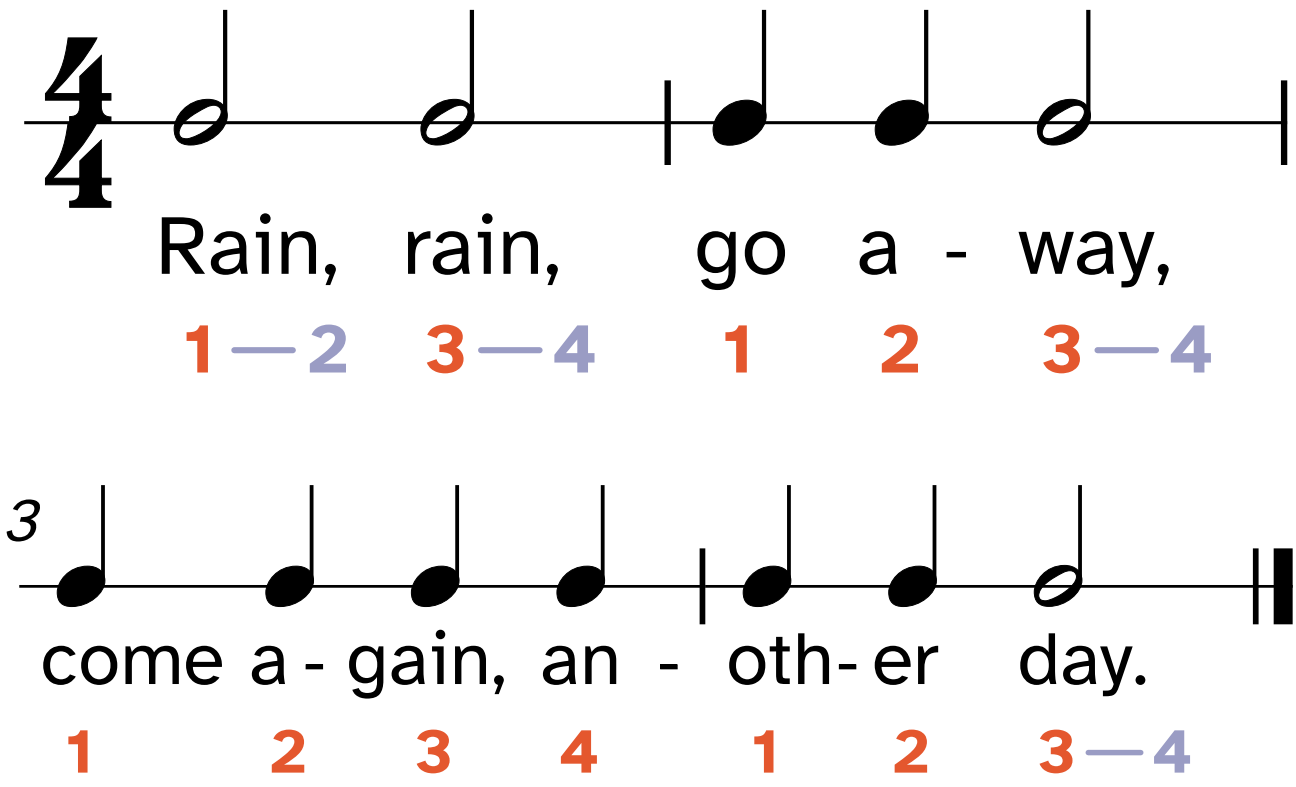
IN THIS SONG **two notes: G and E** · **high and low** · **crotchet and minim** · **fingers 1 and 3**

1 Say and clap

Say the words in time, then clap them and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

THE TIME — 4/4 **Count 1 2 3 4** in every bar, steady as a clock. The 4 on top says four beats a bar.

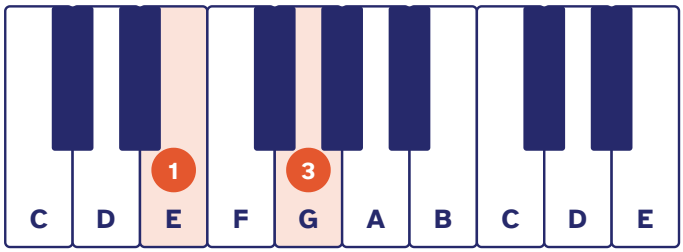
THE NOTES — **crotchet** 1 beat ● · **minim** 2 beats ●●



☐ Said it in time ☐ Clapped and counted ☐ Found every minim (2 beats)

2 Listen and sing

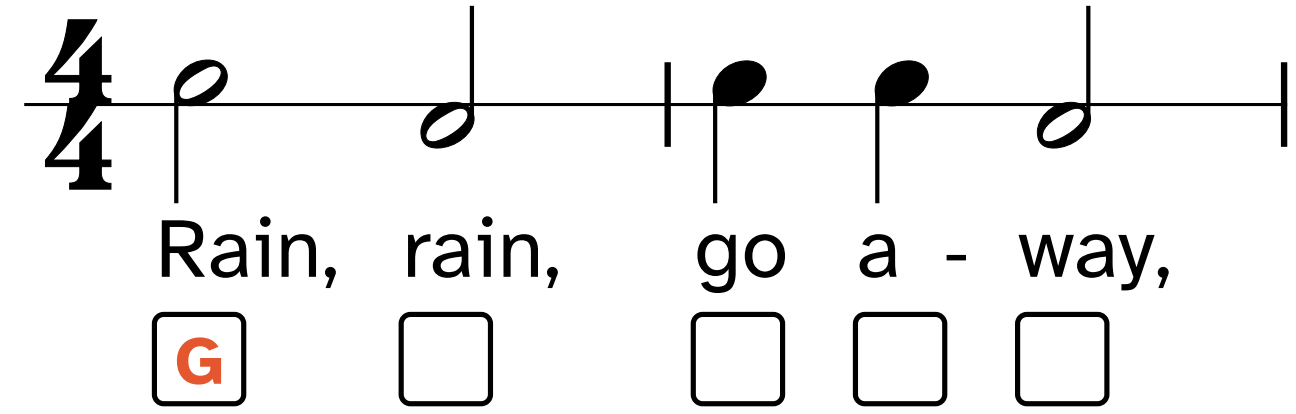
Listen first, pointing to each note as it sounds. Then sing. Write the letter name of every note in the boxes; the first one is done.

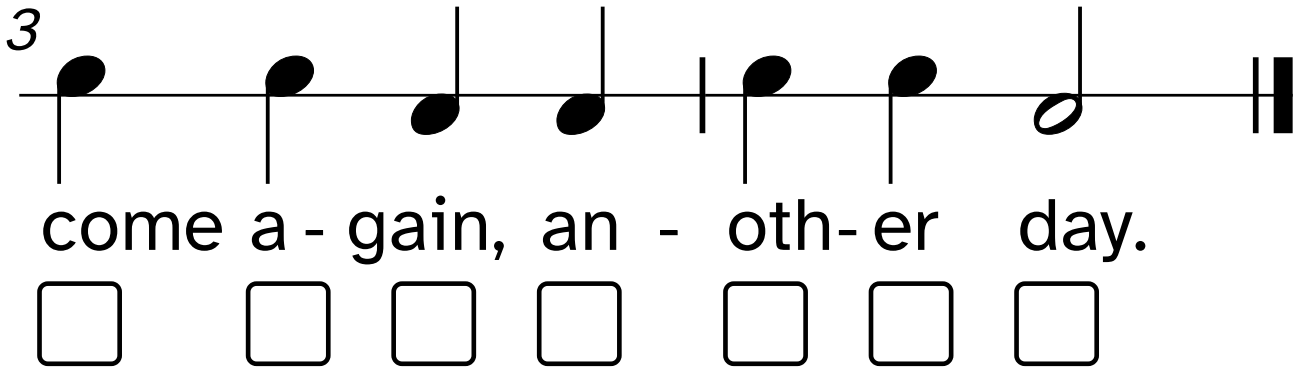


middle C

Your hand. Right thumb (1) on E, finger 3 on G: skip the key between.

High and low. G sounds higher than E. On the page, the high note sits above the line and the low note below it.



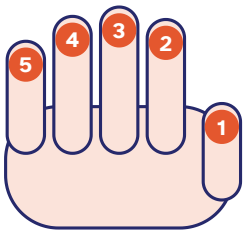


- ☐ **Listened and pointed**
- ☐ **Sang it with the words**
- ☐ **Wrote the letter names**
- ☐ **Sang it on G and E**

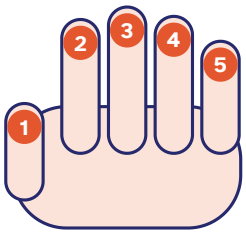
SCAN ME

3 Hello, piano

Three things every pianist knows. Read them with your teacher, then try each one.



LEFT HAND

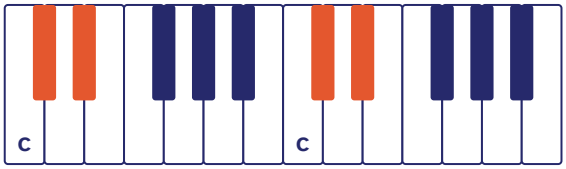


RIGHT HAND

Your fingers have numbers

Thumbs are 1, little fingers are 5, in both hands. Hold your hands up and wiggle each number your teacher calls.

- [ ] **Wiggled 1 to 5, each hand**



Black keys come in twos and threes

Play every group of two black keys, low to high, then every group of three. C is the white key just left of each two.

- [ ] **Found the twos and threes**
- [ ] **Found every C**

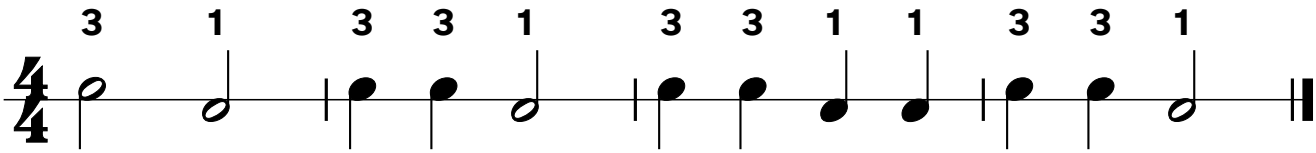
Sit like a pianist

Sit on the front half of the bench, feet flat. Elbows a little in front of you, level with the keys. Round hands, as if holding a small ball.

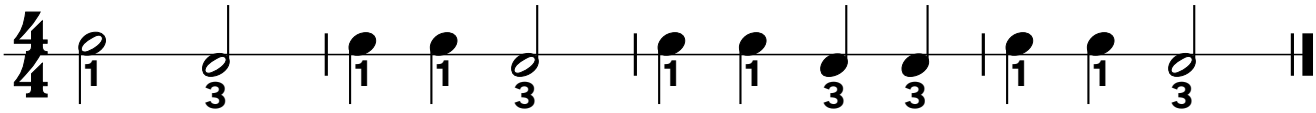
4 Play it

Right hand: thumb (1) on E, finger 3 on G. Then the left hand an octave lower: finger 3 on E, thumb on G. The numbers swap, because your hands are mirrors.

RIGHT HAND



LEFT HAND



5 · CHECK

- [ ] **I can say and clap it**
- [ ] **I can sing it with the words**
- [ ] **I can name its notes**

I can play it:

- [ ] **Right hand**
- [ ] **Left hand**

TEACHER [ ] **Pass** [ ] **Not yet**